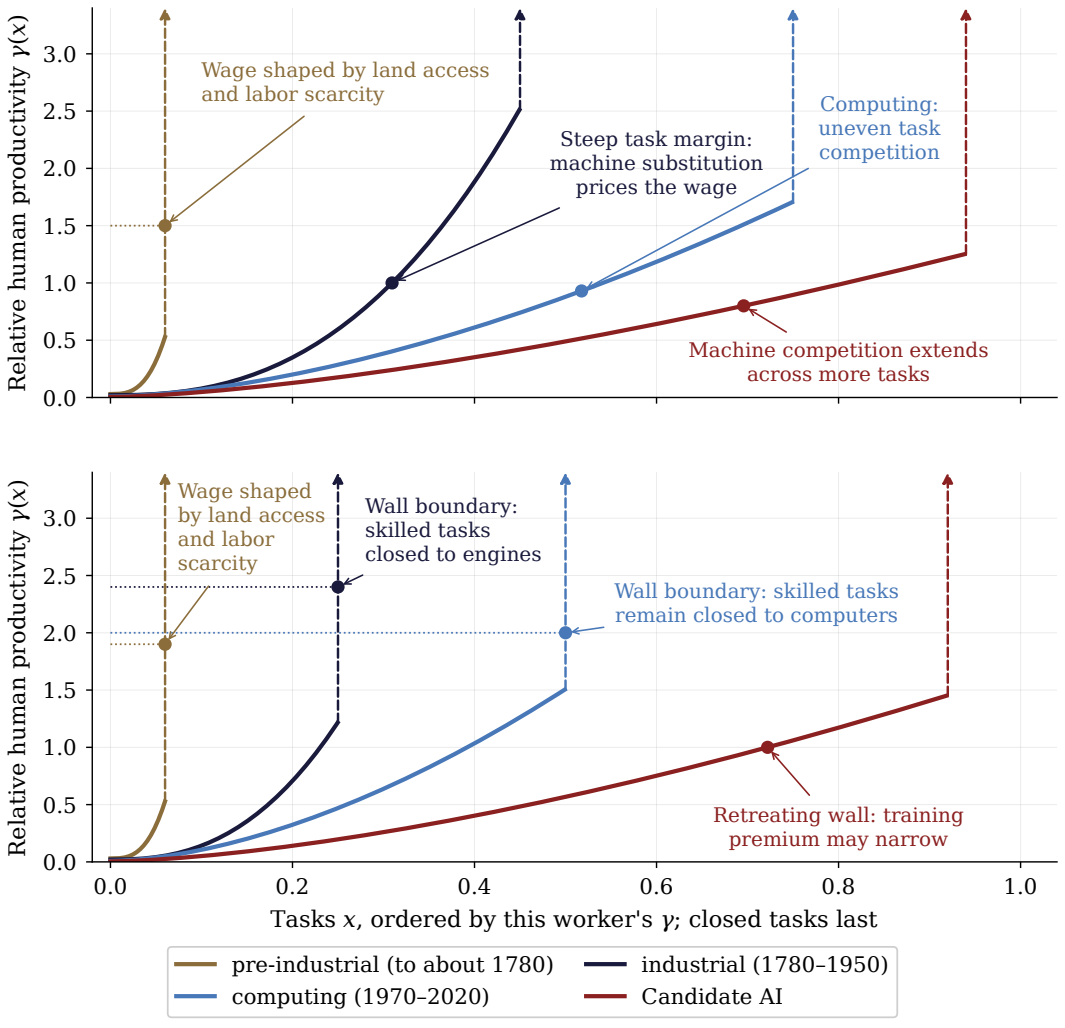
Relative human productivity $y(x)$
Wage shaped by land access and labor scarcity
Steep task margin: machine substitution prices the wage
Computing: uneven task competition
Machine competition extends across more tasks
Wage shaped by land access and labor scarcity
Wall boundary: skilled tasks closed to engines
Wall boundary: skilled tasks remain closed to computers
Retreating wall: training premium may narrow
Tasks x, ordered by this worker's y; closed tasks last
pre-industrial (to about 1780)
industrial (1780–1950)
computing (1970–2020)
Candidate AI